

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Marketing English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For brand, product marketing, growth, content, SEO, lifecycle, demand generation, marketing operations, social, and agency teams.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Positioning, Messaging, Brand Voice, and Proof

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

03 Campaign Briefs, GTM Planning, and Cross-Functional Alignment

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

04 Content, SEO, Thought Leadership, and Editorial Judgment

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

05 Paid Media, Performance Marketing, and Attribution

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

06 Lifecycle, CRM, Email, Marketing Ops, and Sales Handoff

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

07 Analytics, Experimentation, Funnel Reporting, and Executive Readouts

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

08 Compliance, Privacy, Claims, Influencers, Brand Safety, and Crisis Response

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A campaign brief targets "everyone who works in an office." The product is a scheduling tool, but the buyer and daily user may differ.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Segment - A meaningful subset of the market based on shared traits, needs, behavior, or value.

ICP - Ideal customer profile; the type of account or customer most likely to succeed and create value.

Persona - A model of a target user, buyer, or influencer used to guide messaging and content.

JTBD - Jobs to be done; what the customer is trying to accomplish in a situation.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - B. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - C. Could you confirm when starts the review?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - B. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - C. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The scheduling buyer may not be the user

The lesson's scheduling-tool brief targets everyone in an office; the buyer and daily user have not been identified.

01 • Marketing strategist: The brief targets everyone who works in an office. Who actually buys this scheduling tool?

02 • Product manager: We haven't separated the buyer from the daily user, so that audience is too broad.

03 • Marketing strategist: Could we clarify whose problem the campaign needs to address before creating a persona?

04 • Product manager: Yes. A purchasing decision and a daily scheduling task may involve different people.

05 • Marketing strategist: Then an ideal customer profile, or ICP, shouldn't simply repeat everyone in an office.

06 • Product manager: Agreed. We need evidence about the relevant organization and the roles involved.

07 • Marketing strategist: What job to be done, or JTBD, should the research investigate first?

08 • Product manager: The actual scheduling difficulty. We haven't established which difficulty matters most, so let's ask rather than invent it.

09 • Marketing strategist: I'll separate segment, buyer, user, and unanswered problem questions in the discussion.

10 • Product manager: Good. We can define the campaign outcome once that audience understanding is clearer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

One signup list contains two different needs

Separate fictional research exercise: event signups include office managers seeking room booking and recruiters seeking interview coordination; purchasing authority is unknown.

01 • Demand generation lead: Can we treat this signup list as one persona because everyone requested scheduling information?

02 • Researcher: The stated needs differ: office managers mention room booking, while recruiters mention interview coordination.

03 • Demand generation lead: So the shared topic doesn't establish a shared job to be done.

04 • Researcher: Exactly. We should clarify the desired task and who participates in the purchase.

05 • Demand generation lead: Could we assume the office managers control budget because of their titles?

06 • Researcher: No. Purchasing authority hasn't been established for either group in this exercise.

07 • Demand generation lead: Then I'll ask which workflow each contact wants to improve before choosing the campaign message.

08 • Researcher: Also distinguish expressed interest from evidence that the segment matches our ideal customer profile.

09 • Demand generation lead: I'll keep the two stated needs separate and avoid inventing budget ownership.

10 • Researcher: Good. That gives us focused discovery questions instead of a persona built from job-title assumptions.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A productivity goal needs a named task

Separate fictional campaign intake: a team wants to promote a document tool as improving productivity, but no target task or desired behavior is specified.

01 • Campaign planner: When you say productivity, which task should the audience be able to complete more effectively?

02 • Product lead: We haven't chosen a task. The brief currently describes the entire document tool.

03 • Campaign planner: Then we need clarification before deciding on a segment or a useful outcome.

04 • Product lead: Could a broad message work until we have more detailed audience evidence?

05 • Campaign planner: It might be a hypothesis, but we shouldn't call it a validated value proposition.

06 • Product lead: What would you ask first in the research conversation with a potential user?

07 • Campaign planner: Which document task creates difficulty, and what would a successful result look like?

08 • Product lead: That would help distinguish a feature request from the job they actually need done.

09 • Campaign planner: Yes. We'll keep any persona provisional until the evidence supports a more specific description.

10 • Product lead: Let's clarify the task and outcome before asking creative to produce campaign concepts.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

A campaign brief targets "everyone who works in an office." The product is a scheduling tool, but the buyer and daily user may differ.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Who decides to buy the tool, and who uses it each day? Let's define a specific audience and the problem we are solving before choosing the campaign message.

Scenario 2 | A webinar audience with unverified buying roles

A fictional webinar attracted trainers and procurement staff. The next campaign must invite product demonstrations, but no one has checked which group uses the product or influences purchasing.

Role A: You plan the campaign. Ask about role and purpose before treating attendance as buying intent.

Role B: You own webinar research. Explain the known attendee groups and missing decision-role information.

Possible opening: We know who attended by job category, but not who uses the product or influences its purchase.

Success checks

- Distinguish attendance from purchase intent.
- Name both supplied attendee groups.
- Agree a focused question about user and buyer roles.

Add a complication: A sponsor wants to label every attendee a qualified buyer.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Positioning, Messaging, Brand Voice, and Proof

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A draft advertisement says "the fastest tool on the market." The only evidence is an internal test against one earlier version.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Positioning - How a brand or product should be understood relative to alternatives.

Value proposition - Specific value promised to a specific audience, supported by proof.

Proof point - Evidence that supports a claim, such as data, customer story, demo, or benchmark.

Brand promise - The core expectation a brand creates for customers.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change must have caused the delay.
 - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - C. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An earlier-version test cannot prove fastest in market

Separate fictional extension of the lesson: an internal test exported the same 100-row report in eight seconds on the new version and ten on the earlier version, on the same test machine. No market-wide or other-task comparison exists.

01 • Copywriter: The headline says fastest tool on the market. Our proof point is an internal comparison with the earlier version.

02 • Brand reviewer: That test doesn't cover the whole market, so the positioning claim exceeds the evidence.

03 • Copywriter: Could we say faster than our earlier version instead, with the test conditions visible?

04 • Brand reviewer: Only within what the test actually measured. We shouldn't imply every task or environment improved.

05 • Copywriter: Then the brand promise needs to be narrower than the ambitious headline I drafted.

06 • Brand reviewer: Yes. Clear qualification can preserve a useful message without pretending a broader comparison occurred.

07 • Copywriter: I'll propose: In our internal 100-row report-export test, the new version took eight seconds versus ten previously.

08 • Brand reviewer: Good. Keep the actual test reference available to whoever checks that wording.

09 • Copywriter: We can develop a value proposition around the supported benefit rather than a market-wide superlative.

10 • Brand reviewer: Exactly. The revised claim should tell readers what was tested, not what we hope is true.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Three customer quotes are not universal experience

Separate fictional messaging review: three interviewees describe a tool as easy to learn; no broader usability study exists.

01 • Brand manager: Three interviewees said the tool was easy to learn. Can our message say anyone masters it immediately?

02 • Customer researcher: No. Those comments describe three experiences, not a universal learning outcome or measured completion time.

03 • Brand manager: Could we use the comments as a proof point without turning them into that promise?

04 • Customer researcher: We can consider accurately attributed feedback, subject to the relevant use review and context.

05 • Brand manager: We haven't measured how long learning took, so immediately would add an unsupported fact.

06 • Customer researcher: Correct. And anyone would extend three accounts to every potential user.

07 • Brand manager: I'll propose wording that describes the interview feedback rather than guarantees mastery.

08 • Customer researcher: Please retain the limited sample and avoid presenting the interviews as a comprehensive study.

09 • Brand manager: That still supports a discussion about accessible onboarding while keeping the brand promise honest.

10 • Customer researcher: Yes. Then further research can test whether the broader positioning is justified.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A feature exists, but the benefit is unmeasured

Separate fictional launch: a product adds reusable templates; no measured time-saving study has been conducted.

01 • Product marketer: We now have reusable templates. Can the value proposition promise to cut preparation time in half?

02 • Product manager: The feature exists, but we haven't measured that time-saving claim in a study.

03 • Product marketer: Then the capability is observed, while the fifty-percent benefit is only an unsupported assumption.

04 • Product manager: Exactly. We can explain that users can reuse a template without inventing the resulting savings.

05 • Product marketer: How about create a template once and reuse it for later documents?

06 • Product manager: That describes the supplied capability, provided the final wording matches the feature's actual scope.

07 • Product marketer: I'll take that wording for review and remove the numerical promise.

08 • Product manager: Good. A brand promise should not turn a plausible benefit into a measured proof point.

09 • Product marketer: We can propose a later task-based study if we want to quantify the benefit.

10 • Product manager: Yes. Until then, capability and measured outcome should remain separate in our messaging.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Positioning, Messaging, Brand Voice, and Proof

A draft advertisement says "the fastest tool on the market." The only evidence is an internal test against one earlier version.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The test supports a comparison with our earlier version, not the whole market. Could we use a narrower claim that accurately describes what we measured and send it for review?

Scenario 2 | A pilot testimonial mentions an unsupported saving

A fictional pilot customer says they felt more organized. A draft testimonial caption translates that into saved ten hours weekly. No time measurement or customer statement supports the number.

Role A: You review brand claims. Explain the difference between the customer's statement and the invented caption.

Role B: You are the copywriter. Offer a bounded replacement based only on the supplied feedback.

Possible opening: The customer described feeling more organized; the ten-hour saving isn't in the evidence.

Success checks

- Reject the unsupported numerical claim.
- Preserve the customer's actual limited feedback.
- Offer revised wording for review without inventing permission to publish the quote.

Add a complication: A stakeholder asks you to keep the number because it makes the message concrete.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Campaign Briefs, GTM Planning, and Cross-Functional Alignment

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

A launch brief has a date and channel list but no audience, approved message, or measure of success.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Creative brief - Document that guides creative work with audience, objective, insight, message, mandates, and constraints.

GTM - Go-to-market plan for launching or growing a product, feature, offer, or market motion.

Buyer journey - Stages a buyer moves through from awareness to evaluation, decision, purchase, and adoption.

Sales enablement - Materials and training that help sales communicate value and move opportunities forward.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
 - B. Send it no later than Thursday.
 - C. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - B. Could you confirm that the review is important?
 - C. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A launch date is not a complete brief

The lesson's launch brief has a date and channels but lacks audience, approved message, and success measure.

01 • Campaign manager: Could you confirm the target audience, approved message, and success measure before creative production begins?

02 • Launch sponsor: The date and channels are already listed. What specifically is missing from the creative brief?

03 • Campaign manager: Who we address, what we can say, and which outcome will define success.

04 • Launch sponsor: Could the creative team decide all three while making the channel assets?

05 • Campaign manager: They can contribute, but we shouldn't silently give them approval responsibility that hasn't been agreed.

06 • Launch sponsor: Then ask the relevant owners to resolve those three items in the GTM discussion.

07 • Campaign manager: I'll request that input before confirming production scope, without inventing a new approval deadline.

08 • Launch sponsor: Please also explain where sales enablement fits once the message is approved.

09 • Campaign manager: It needs the agreed message and buyer-journey context, not simply copies of every advertisement.

10 • Launch sponsor: Good. Bring the missing decisions and their owners into the launch review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Sales needs a demonstration question, not another banner

Separate fictional launch: sales has received campaign banners but no approved discovery questions for a new scheduling feature.

01 • Sales enablement lead: Could product marketing provide approved discovery questions for the new feature before our demonstration rehearsal?

02 • Product marketer: We already supplied banners. What additional need does this request address?

03 • Sales enablement lead: The team needs to ask about the buyer's scheduling problem, not repeat a banner headline.

04 • Product marketer: So the buyer-journey stage is a conversation about needs rather than initial awareness.

05 • Sales enablement lead: Exactly. Could you coordinate the questions with the message owner for review?

06 • Product marketer: Yes, but I need the rehearsal timing before I can confirm delivery.

07 • Sales enablement lead: I'll supply that separately. Please don't describe the questions as approved while review is pending.

08 • Product marketer: Understood. I'll request the relevant use cases and produce a reviewable proposal.

09 • Sales enablement lead: The bounded outcome is a set of usable spoken discovery questions for that rehearsal.

10 • Product marketer: I'll confirm scope and timing after the owner reviews what is needed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A localization request needs an approved source

Separate fictional GTM exercise: a localization lead receives two English message versions, neither marked approved, for a regional launch.

01 • Localization lead: Could you identify the approved source message before we localize these launch materials?

02 • Campaign owner: There are two English versions. Can you choose whichever reads more naturally?

03 • Localization lead: I can flag language issues, but choosing the brand claim would exceed the localization request.

04 • Campaign owner: You're asking for a message decision, not merely a preference about wording.

05 • Localization lead: Correct. The creative brief needs one approved source or clear instructions about the alternatives.

06 • Campaign owner: I'll ask the message owner to resolve that before confirming the regional asset scope.

07 • Localization lead: Please also state the audience so the localization fits the intended buyer-journey stage.

08 • Campaign owner: I'll include that request and avoid promising a delivery date before the source is settled.

09 • Localization lead: Once those inputs are confirmed, I can assess effort and give a realistic schedule.

10 • Campaign owner: Agreed. We'll resolve the dependency rather than treat translation as approval of the original claims.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Campaign Briefs, GTM Planning, and Cross-Functional Alignment

A launch brief has a date and channel list but no audience, approved message, or measure of success.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you add the primary audience, approved message, and success measure before Thursday's review? Those details will help the content and channel teams work toward the same outcome.

Scenario 2 | A launch rehearsal lacks a demonstration owner

A fictional launch rehearsal is planned, but no one owns the product demonstration. Marketing owns the introduction; product has not confirmed who can demonstrate the feature.

Role A: You coordinate the rehearsal. Request a named demonstration owner and availability confirmation.

Role B: You are the product lead. Clarify the demonstration scope before committing a presenter.

Possible opening: Could product confirm who can own the demonstration and what scope they can rehearse?

Success checks

- Separate the introduction from the product demonstration.
- Request scope and a confirmed owner.
- Keep presenter availability unconfirmed until checked.

Add a complication: The sponsor asks marketing to announce a presenter whose availability is still unknown.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Content, SEO, Thought Leadership, and Editorial Judgment

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A proposed article targets a popular keyword, but searchers appear to want instructions while the draft is a product announcement.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Search intent - The likely goal behind a search query.

Keyword - A word or phrase targeted because people search for it.

SERP - Search engine results page: the page displaying results for a search query.

Content brief - Instructions for a content asset, including audience, intent, angle, claims, proof, and CTA.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - B. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
 - C. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?
 - B. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?
 - C. How would you describe the next step in your own words?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Instructions versus an announcement

The lesson's proposed article targets a keyword whose searchers appear to want instructions, while the draft announces a product.

01 • Content editor: The keyword looks popular, but searchers appear to want instructions and our draft is a product announcement.

02 • SEO specialist: That suggests a search-intent mismatch. Popularity alone doesn't establish that the article answers the query.

03 • Content editor: Could you explain search intent without relying on search-marketing terminology?

04 • SEO specialist: It's the task or answer a person seems to be seeking when they search.

05 • Content editor: So mentioning the keyword repeatedly wouldn't turn the announcement into a useful how-to article.

06 • SEO specialist: Correct. We should review the results page and the user's likely task before revising the content brief.

07 • Content editor: The evidence says appear to want instructions, not that every searcher has an identical intention.

08 • SEO specialist: Exactly. Keep that uncertainty while deciding whether to create instructional content or target a different query.

09 • Content editor: I'll bring those two editorial options instead of adding more repetitions of the keyword.

10 • SEO specialist: Good. Match the article's purpose to evidence about the task, not just search volume.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A comparison query needs a comparison

Separate fictional editorial exercise: a draft targets 'tool A versus tool B' but describes only tool A; no tool B research has been completed.

01 • Editorial lead: Our title promises a comparison, but the draft describes only tool A's features.

02 • SEO analyst: That doesn't fulfill the apparent comparison intent of the query we chose.

03 • Editorial lead: Could we add a sentence saying tool B is less flexible to complete it?

04 • SEO analyst: No. We haven't researched tool B, so that would invent a comparative claim.

05 • Editorial lead: Then a comparison article needs matched criteria, whereas a product overview can describe one tool.

06 • SEO analyst: Exactly. The content brief should identify which kind of article we can support.

07 • Editorial lead: I'll either request evidence for a genuine comparison or revise the scope and title.

08 • SEO analyst: Please avoid assuming a search-results-page format guarantees performance; we're making an editorial choice.

09 • Editorial lead: Understood. We can explain how the proposed article answers the searcher's task without promising rankings.

10 • SEO analyst: Good. The title and evidence should match before the keyword becomes the publishing rationale.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An expert opinion is not a measured industry trend

Separate fictional thought-leadership draft: one internal expert predicts more asynchronous meetings; no industry dataset supports the prediction.

01 • Thought leadership editor: The expert expects more asynchronous meetings. Our draft calls that a measured industry shift.

02 • Research lead: An informed opinion and a measured trend aren't the same kind of evidence.

03 • Thought leadership editor: Could we retain the idea by presenting it as the expert's outlook?

04 • Research lead: Yes, with accurate attribution and review, rather than implying a dataset we don't have.

05 • Thought leadership editor: So the content brief should distinguish the argument from factual claims requiring support.

06 • Research lead: Exactly. A thought-leadership article can make a reasoned case without pretending every premise is observed.

07 • Thought leadership editor: I'll explain why the expert expects the change and keep the prediction clearly labeled.

08 • Research lead: Also avoid choosing a keyword that promises current statistics when the piece provides an outlook.

09 • Thought leadership editor: That would create another search-intent mismatch, even if the topic is relevant.

10 • Research lead: Right. Align the article's promise, evidence, and intended reader question before publication review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Content, SEO, Thought Leadership, and Editorial Judgment

A proposed article targets a popular keyword, but searchers appear to want instructions while the draft is a product announcement.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: The search intent appears to be instructional. Our draft announces a product instead. We could create a useful how-to article and include the product only where it helps answer the question.

Scenario 2 | A definition page becomes a sales pitch

A fictional content brief targets 'What is a shared calendar?' The supplied meaning is a calendar that multiple authorized people can view to coordinate schedules; editing depends on permissions. The draft begins with three pricing paragraphs and never defines the term. No ranking result is supplied.

Role A: You are the editor. Explain the difference between answering a definition query and promoting a product.

Role B: You own the draft. Say a revised opening that explains a shared calendar using the supplied meaning, before any relevant product context.

Possible opening: The searcher is asking what the term means, but our opening discusses prices instead.

Success checks

- Identify the unanswered definition need.
- Propose an answer-first editorial sequence.
- Avoid promising a ranking or conversion result from the revision.

Add a complication: A stakeholder insists that answering the question would reduce sales opportunities.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Paid Media, Performance Marketing, and Attribution

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

Paid conversions rose after a campaign change, but a discount began in the same week. A slide credits the campaign with the entire increase.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Attribution - Assigning credit to marketing touchpoints for an outcome.

CPA - Cost per acquisition or action, depending on the defined conversion.

ROAS - Return on ad spend; revenue attributed to ads divided by ad spend.

Incrementality - Additional outcome caused by marketing that would not have happened otherwise.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change must have caused the delay.
 - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - C. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The discount changed alongside the campaign

The lesson's paid conversions increased after a campaign change, while a discount began in the same week.

01 • Paid media manager: Paid conversions rose after the campaign change. The slide credits us with the entire increase.

02 • Marketing analyst: A discount began in the same week, so the campaign's contribution isn't isolated.

03 • Paid media manager: Can attribution reporting tell us that the additional conversions would not otherwise have happened?

04 • Marketing analyst: Not by itself. Attribution assigns credit under a method; incrementality asks about additional outcomes caused.

05 • Paid media manager: Then the observed rise is real in the report, but the causal explanation is incomplete.

06 • Marketing analyst: Correct. We should state both changes and avoid treating credited conversions as proof of incremental lift.

07 • Paid media manager: I'll remove the full-causation claim and show the discount as a concurrent factor.

08 • Marketing analyst: Please also keep CPA and ROAS definitions consistent if they're used in the comparison.

09 • Paid media manager: We'll propose a better-controlled assessment rather than guess each factor's share of the increase.

10 • Marketing analyst: Good. The update can report improvement without overstating what caused it.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Lower CPA with a different conversion definition

Separate fictional reporting exercise: last month's CPA used purchases, while this month's uses trial signups. No purchase-based current CPA is supplied.

01 • Campaign director: This month's CPA is lower. Can we say it costs less to acquire a paying customer?

02 • Performance analyst: The conversion definition changed from purchases to trial signups, so that conclusion isn't supported.

03 • Campaign director: Then we're comparing costs per different actions even though the dashboard uses the same label.

04 • Performance analyst: Exactly. The lower number doesn't establish a lower cost per purchase.

05 • Campaign director: Could we assume every trial eventually becomes a purchase to make the comparison work?

06 • Performance analyst: No. We don't have that evidence, and the assumption would change the meaning substantially.

07 • Campaign director: I'll label each conversion action and request the current purchase-based calculation.

08 • Performance analyst: Good. Keep the reported signup result, but don't turn it into customer-acquisition evidence.

09 • Campaign director: The executive summary will say the apparent improvement needs a matched-definition check.

10 • Performance analyst: Then we can assess actual performance rather than credit a metric-definition change to the campaign.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

ROAS is not a profit calculation

Separate fictional campaign dataset: advertising spend is \$1,000 and attributed revenue is \$4,000; product costs, returns, and attribution validity are unassessed.

01 • Media buyer: The report has one thousand dollars in spend and four thousand in attributed revenue, a four-times ROAS.

02 • Finance partner: Does that establish three thousand dollars of campaign profit after subtracting the advertising spend?

03 • Media buyer: No. Product costs and returns aren't included, and attributed revenue isn't automatically incremental revenue.

04 • Finance partner: Then return on ad spend describes that revenue-to-ad-spend ratio, not complete profitability.

05 • Media buyer: Correct. We can report the ratio under the stated attribution method without claiming net profit.

06 • Finance partner: Should we also review whether the credited purchases overlap with another channel's report?

07 • Media buyer: Yes. Attribution validity remains unassessed in this dataset, so duplication can't be ruled out.

08 • Finance partner: I'll keep the arithmetic and the unresolved economic questions separate in the review.

09 • Media buyer: I'll provide the attribution basis and request the missing cost information.

10 • Finance partner: Good. Four-times reported ROAS is a bounded observation, not a proven profit or causal return.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Paid Media, Performance Marketing, and Attribution

Paid conversions rose after a campaign change, but a discount began in the same week. A slide credits the campaign with the entire increase.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: Conversions rose after the campaign change, but the discount is another possible influence. I'll describe the timing accurately and avoid claiming that the campaign caused the entire increase.

Scenario 2 | An attribution window grows longer

A fictional platform's reported conversions rise after its attribution window changes from seven to thirty days. Campaign settings are otherwise unchanged in the supplied record. No incremental-sales study exists.

Role A: You are the performance analyst. Explain how the reporting change affects interpretation.

Role B: You are the campaign manager. Ask for a constant-window comparison before claiming improved effectiveness.

Possible opening: The attribution window expanded, so the increase may reflect which conversions are counted rather than new effectiveness.

Success checks

- Name the seven-to-thirty-day change.
- Avoid treating attributed growth as incremental sales.
- Agree a comparison using the same attribution window.

Add a complication: A sponsor wants to credit the higher total to creative improvements that were not made.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Lifecycle, CRM, Email, Marketing Ops, and Sales Handoff

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

SITUATION

A lead list is ready for sales. It contains contact details but no explanation of which contacts requested a conversation.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

MQL - Marketing-qualified lead based on agreed fit and engagement criteria.

SQL - Sales-qualified lead accepted or qualified by sales for active pursuit.

Nurture - Planned communication that develops interest or readiness over time.

Suppression list - List of contacts excluded from campaigns because of opt-out, risk, irrelevance, or policy.

3. Notice the language

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Compare this wording: Someone should follow up on this.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Transfer information and responsibility

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence checks that responsibility has been accepted?
 - A. The check appears somewhere in the notes.
 - B. Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.
 - C. I mentioned the check in my earlier email.
2. Which response best checks a critical handoff detail?
 - A. So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?
 - B. I assume all results are final, so we can finish.
 - C. I saw the message, so no clarification is needed.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Contacts are not confirmed requests for calls

The lesson's lead list contains contact details but does not identify who requested a conversation.

01 • Marketing operations lead: The contact list is ready, but it doesn't identify which people requested a sales conversation.

02 • Sales development manager: Then I can't treat every record as an SQL ready for direct follow-up.

03 • Marketing operations lead: Correct. We need the qualification and contact-request context before making that handoff claim.

04 • Sales development manager: Does an MQL label in the list establish that a person asked to speak with us?

05 • Marketing operations lead: Not without checking our definitions and the recorded activity. The label alone isn't enough.

06 • Sales development manager: Please separate verified requests from records whose follow-up basis is unresolved.

07 • Marketing operations lead: I'll request that evidence and check the relevant suppression-list status through our process.

08 • Sales development manager: I'll hold off treating the unresolved group as confirmed conversation requests.

09 • Marketing operations lead: Could you confirm what you need to accept the corrected handoff?

10 • Sales development manager: The request evidence, qualification context, and applicable contact restrictions, with unknowns clearly marked.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A nurture handoff needs the actual last interaction

Separate fictional lifecycle exercise: three contacts attended a webinar and remain in nurture; no demo request is recorded.

01 • Lifecycle marketer: These three contacts attended the webinar and remain in nurture. No demonstration request is recorded.

02 • Account executive: Are you handing them to me as sales-qualified leads or sharing engagement context only?

03 • Lifecycle marketer: Engagement context only. Attendance doesn't establish readiness for a sales conversation.

04 • Account executive: Then please don't title the handoff three ready-to-buy accounts.

05 • Lifecycle marketer: Agreed. I'll include the recorded interaction and the limits of what it shows.

06 • Account executive: Who will check whether a later request or relevant restriction exists in the CRM?

07 • Lifecycle marketer: I'll ask marketing operations to verify the current record before any status change.

08 • Account executive: Good. I won't infer a request from the webinar attendance alone.

09 • Lifecycle marketer: I'll return the verified context and distinguish an MQL assessment from any SQL decision.

10 • Account executive: That gives sales useful information without turning a nurture event into an invented buying signal.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A suppression flag stays visible at handoff

Separate fictional CRM handoff: one contact appears on a campaign list and a suppression list; the reason for suppression has not been checked.

01 • CRM specialist: One contact appears in both the campaign list and the suppression list. I'm flagging the conflict.

02 • Campaign coordinator: Can I delete the suppression flag so the list is complete for handoff?

03 • CRM specialist: No. We need to understand the restriction through the appropriate process before any outreach decision.

04 • Campaign coordinator: Do we know why the flag exists, or are we still checking?

05 • CRM specialist: The reason hasn't been checked. I won't invent consent history or assume an error.

06 • Campaign coordinator: Then the handoff should identify the record as requiring review, not as cleared for contact.

07 • CRM specialist: Exactly. I'll provide the internal reference and request the restriction review from the responsible owner.

08 • Campaign coordinator: I'll keep it out of any assumed cleared group while that question remains unresolved.

09 • CRM specialist: Please confirm the boundary when you brief the receiving team.

10 • Campaign coordinator: I'll state that list membership doesn't override the unresolved suppression status or authorize outreach.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Lifecycle, CRM, Email, Marketing Ops, and Sales Handoff

A lead list is ready for sales. It contains contact details but no explanation of which contacts requested a conversation.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Second round: The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Model for scenario 1: The handoff needs the agreed qualification fields and contact permissions. I'll distinguish conversation requests from other activity so sales can choose an appropriate follow-up under our process.

Scenario 2 | A lead asks for a different follow-up channel

A fictional lead requested a product conversation by email, but the handoff summary says call requested. No phone-contact request is recorded.

Role A: You prepare the handoff. Correct the requested channel and state the available evidence.

Role B: You are the sales recipient. Confirm the channel and ask how the request is recorded.

Possible opening: The lead requested an email conversation; the call-request label is inaccurate.

Success checks

- Preserve the email request accurately.
- Do not invent permission for another channel.
- Confirm the corrected handoff and evidence reference.

Add a complication: A colleague says a phone call would be faster and wants to ignore the recorded preference.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Analytics, Experimentation, Funnel Reporting, and Executive Readouts

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

An email experiment records 120 clicks from 2,000 delivered messages in version A and 140 from 2,000 in version B. No significance analysis is complete.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

CTR - Click-through rate; clicks divided by impressions.

Lift test - Experiment estimating causal impact by comparing exposed and control groups.

Cohort - Group of users or customers sharing a time period, behavior, or trait.

Vanity metric - Metric that looks impressive but does not support a real decision.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Compare this wording: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team has completed the review.
 - B. The team is completing the review.
 - C. The team plans to complete the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.
 - B. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.
 - C. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

One percentage point with significance still pending

The lesson's email test records A: 120 clicks from 2,000 deliveries; B: 140 from 2,000. Significance analysis is incomplete.

01 • Experiment analyst: Version A has a six-percent click rate; B has seven percent, from two thousand deliveries each.

02 • Marketing director: Then can we announce B as the proven winner of the experiment?

03 • Experiment analyst: Not yet. The observed difference is one percentage point, and significance analysis remains incomplete.

04 • Marketing director: What part of the report can we confidently share today?

05 • Experiment analyst: The supplied counts, delivered-message denominator, and observed rates, clearly separated from the pending inference.

06 • Marketing director: Could we call the change a one-percent relative increase in CTR?

07 • Experiment analyst: No. It's one percentage point; the relative increase from six to seven is about sixteen-point-seven percent.

08 • Marketing director: I'll use the correct description and avoid calling the result conclusive.

09 • Experiment analyst: I'll complete the planned checks and report the uncertainty before recommending a rollout.

10 • Marketing director: Good. A measured difference is progress, but it isn't the finished experiment conclusion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 · CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A cohort report with a shorter observation window

Separate fictional funnel report: one signup cohort has thirty days of follow-up, another only ten; final conversion comparison is pending.

01 · Growth manager: The newer cohort has fewer purchases. Can we report that its conversion performance is worse?

02 · Analytics lead: It has only ten days of follow-up, while the older cohort has thirty.

03 · Growth manager: Then the data collection is at different stages, not a completed matched-window comparison.

04 · Analytics lead: Correct. We can report observed activity, but the unequal observation periods limit the conclusion.

05 · Growth manager: Could we compare the first ten days of both cohorts if that data is available?

06 · Analytics lead: That would align the window, but availability and other differences still need checking.

07 · Growth manager: I'll label the newer cohort as still maturing rather than a confirmed failure.

08 · Analytics lead: Please keep the actual counts visible; we don't need to hide incomplete results.

09 · Growth manager: The pending action is a matched-window check, not an automatic campaign change.

10 · Analytics lead: Exactly. We'll distinguish the available observations from the analysis needed to interpret them.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A funnel count waits for duplicate review

Separate fictional analytics exercise: a dashboard counts 300 form submissions; duplicate-person checks have not been completed.

01 • Executive reporting lead: The dashboard shows three hundred submissions. May I call that three hundred new people in the funnel?

02 • Marketing analyst: Not yet. We haven't checked whether some people submitted more than once.

03 • Executive reporting lead: So submission events and unique people are different measures, even if the number looks useful.

04 • Marketing analyst: Exactly. Calling events people would overstate what the completed counting step establishes.

05 • Executive reporting lead: Does that make the submission count a vanity metric we should discard entirely?

06 • Marketing analyst: Not necessarily. It can serve a purpose if labeled correctly and linked to the question we're answering.

07 • Executive reporting lead: I'll show submissions now and mark the unique-person calculation as pending.

08 • Marketing analyst: Good. The duplicate review should use a defined method rather than remove records arbitrarily.

09 • Executive reporting lead: Then we'll update the funnel readout when that check is complete.

10 • Marketing analyst: Yes, and explain any revised count instead of silently changing what the original metric meant.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Analytics, Experimentation, Funnel Reporting, and Executive Readouts

An email experiment records 120 clicks from 2,000 delivered messages in version A and 140 from 2,000 in version B. No significance analysis is complete.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The observed click rates are 6% and 7%. Version B is higher in this sample, but we have not established whether the difference is reliable. Let's complete the planned analysis before naming a winner.

Scenario 2 | A lift test has missing outcome data

A fictional lift test has complete exposure counts for both groups, but purchase outcomes for one day are missing. No final lift estimate is approved.

Role A: You are the experiment analyst. Report what is complete and the missing outcome period.

Role B: You own the executive update. Ask how to present the gap without treating missing purchases as zero.

Possible opening: Exposure counts are complete, but one day's purchase outcomes are missing from the analysis.

Success checks

- Separate complete exposure data from incomplete outcomes.
- Do not count missing outcomes as observed zeroes.
- Agree a qualified update and the required data check.

Add a complication: A sponsor wants a final lift number before the missing data is checked.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Compliance, Privacy, Claims, Influencers, Brand Safety, and Crisis Response

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

SITUATION

A scheduled post includes a claim that reviewers have asked to revise. The post has not yet been published.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Substantiation - Evidence supporting express or implied advertising claims before launch.

Material connection - Relationship such as payment, employment, or free product that may require disclosure.

Consent - Permission or legal basis for certain marketing communications or data use.

Brand safety - Controls to reduce placement near harmful or unsuitable content.

3. Notice the language

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Compare this wording: I'm sorry if you failed to understand.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Repair a misunderstanding

4. Check the language

1. Which apology takes responsibility for unclear wording?
 - A. I'm sorry the process took longer than expected.
 - B. I'm sorry we could not meet the original date.
 - C. I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.
2. What should follow an apology for an incorrect date?
 - A. A new guaranteed date even if it is unverified.
 - B. The corrected date and the current confirmation status.
 - C. A longer explanation that never states the correct date.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Correcting a scheduled claim before publication

The lesson's scheduled post contains a claim reviewers asked to revise; it has not been published.

01 • Social media coordinator: The scheduled post still contains the claim reviewers asked us to revise. It hasn't been published.

02 • Brand safety lead: Then we need to correct the draft status and prevent publication of that unreviewed wording.

03 • Social media coordinator: I described it as approved in the handoff. That was inaccurate, and I'll correct the message.

04 • Brand safety lead: Good. Keep the substantiation question visible rather than imply approval occurred.

05 • Social media coordinator: Should I announce that customers have already seen a false claim?

06 • Brand safety lead: No. The supplied fact is that the post is unpublished, not a confirmed public exposure.

07 • Social media coordinator: I'll ask the publishing owner to confirm the hold and route revised wording for review.

08 • Brand safety lead: Please distinguish requesting a hold from a confirmed scheduling change.

09 • Social media coordinator: I'll report the actual status after that check and avoid claiming the issue resolved prematurely.

10 • Brand safety lead: Exactly. The correction should preserve both the review requirement and the publication facts.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A creator relationship omitted from the brief

Separate fictional campaign exercise: a creator receives a free product, but the draft brief says there is no material connection. Nothing has been published.

01 • Creator partnerships manager: The brief says no material connection, but the creator receives a free product in this campaign.

02 • Compliance reviewer: Then the brief's description of the relationship is inaccurate and needs correction before publication review.

03 • Creator partnerships manager: Can we ignore the product because no cash payment is involved in the supplied arrangement?

04 • Compliance reviewer: Don't assume that removes relevance. The actual relationship needs review under the applicable requirements.

05 • Creator partnerships manager: I'll replace the no-connection claim with a factual description of the free product.

06 • Compliance reviewer: Good. Avoid inventing a universal disclosure formula or claiming the revised wording is legally approved.

07 • Creator partnerships manager: The content is still unpublished, so I won't describe this as a completed public violation.

08 • Compliance reviewer: Correct. Ask the responsible reviewer to assess the appropriate communication before release.

09 • Creator partnerships manager: I'll document the brief correction and keep approval status pending.

10 • Compliance reviewer: Then the review starts from accurate facts rather than a misleading compensation assumption.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An image-use assumption needs correction

Separate fictional marketing exercise: a draft uses a customer photo because it appeared on a public website; permission for this use has not been checked.

01 • Content producer: I marked the customer photo cleared because it was visible on a public website.

02 • Marketing reviewer: Public visibility doesn't establish permission for our proposed use. That clearance claim needs correction.

03 • Content producer: The draft hasn't been released. I'll state that permission is unverified rather than already granted.

04 • Marketing reviewer: Good. Keep the consent or rights question with the appropriate review owner.

05 • Content producer: Could we assume the customer would welcome the exposure and publish while we ask?

06 • Marketing reviewer: No. Their likely reaction isn't evidence of authorization, and we shouldn't invent consent.

07 • Content producer: I'll remove the cleared label and request an approved asset or a completed permission check.

08 • Marketing reviewer: Please confirm the draft's actual status before describing any public use or harm.

09 • Content producer: I'll report only the unverified draft use and the corrective step being requested.

10 • Marketing reviewer: That preserves the facts and gives the publishing team a clear unresolved condition.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 · SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Compliance, Privacy, Claims, Influencers, Brand Safety, and Crisis Response

A scheduled post includes a claim that reviewers have asked to revise. The post has not yet been published.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Second round: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for scenario 1: The scheduled wording differs from the reviewed claim. I'll pause publication through our process and send the revised copy for approval. Please confirm which version should replace it.

Scenario 2 | A response draft claims an investigation is complete

A fictional brand-response draft says a customer complaint has been fully investigated. The record shows only that the complaint was received; no review findings exist. The response is unsent.

Role A: You are the communications lead. Correct the unsupported completion claim.

Role B: You are the service reviewer. Explain what can be said now and what needs review before a further response.

Possible opening: We can confirm receipt of the complaint, but not a completed investigation or finding.

Success checks

- Separate receipt from investigation.
- Offer accurate acknowledgment wording without inventing a result.
- Keep the unsent status and next review step explicit.

Add a complication: A stakeholder wants to retain fully investigated to sound reassuring.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: A - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

B: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

C: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

Check 2: C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

B: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

C: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

Model response: Who decides to buy the tool, and who uses it each day? Let's define a specific audience and the problem we are solving before choosing the campaign message.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Positioning, Messaging, Brand Voice, and Proof

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

Model response: The test supports a comparison with our earlier version, not the whole market. Could we use a narrower claim that accurately describes what we measured and send it for review?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Campaign Briefs, GTM Planning, and Cross-Functional Alignment

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: B - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

B: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

C: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

Check 2: A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: The requested action and information are explicit.

B: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

C: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

Model response: Could you add the primary audience, approved message, and success measure before Thursday's review? Those details will help the content and channel teams work toward the same outcome.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Content, SEO, Thought Leadership, and Editorial Judgment

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

B: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

C: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

Check 2: C - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

B: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

C: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

Model response: The search intent appears to be instructional. Our draft announces a product instead. We could create a useful how-to article and include the product only where it helps answer the question.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Paid Media, Performance Marketing, and Attribution

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

Model response: Conversions rose after the campaign change, but the discount is another possible influence. I'll describe the timing accurately and avoid claiming that the campaign caused the entire increase.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Lifecycle, CRM, Email, Marketing Ops, and Sales Handoff

Editing example: Please confirm which team has accepted the follow-up task.

The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

Check 1: B - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.

A: A written record alone does not identify who will act.

B: It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.

C: Mentioning a task does not show that anyone accepted it.

Check 2: A - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?

A: This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

B: It changes pending information into a final result.

C: Receiving a message is not the same as confirming its meaning.

Model response: The handoff needs the agreed qualification fields and contact permissions. I'll distinguish conversation requests from other activity so sales can choose an appropriate follow-up under our process.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Analytics, Experimentation, Funnel Reporting, and Executive Readouts

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: A - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

B: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

C: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

Check 2: C - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

B: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

C: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

Model response: The observed click rates are 6% and 7%. Version B is higher in this sample, but we have not established whether the difference is reliable. Let's complete the planned analysis before naming a winner.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Compliance, Privacy, Claims, Influencers, Brand Safety, and Crisis Response

Editing example: I'm sorry my message did not explain the timing clearly.

The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Check 1: C - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.

A: This acknowledges duration, but does not take responsibility for the unclear wording.

B: This acknowledges a missed date, not the communication problem in the question.

C: This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.

Check 2: B - The corrected date and the current confirmation status.

A: An unsupported new promise can create a second misunderstanding.

B: A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

C: The reader still lacks the information they need.

Model response: The scheduled wording differs from the reviewed claim. I'll pause publication through our process and send the revised copy for approval. Please confirm which version should replace it.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Marketing English

Professional audience: brand, product marketing, growth, content, SEO, lifecycle, demand generation, marketing operations, social, and agency teams

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

Original fictional case: A campaign brief targets "everyone who works in an office." The product is a scheduling tool, but the buyer and daily user may differ.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: Segment: A meaningful subset of the market based on shared traits, needs, behavior, or value. / ICP: Ideal customer profile; the type of account or customer most likely to succeed and create value. / Persona: A model of a target user, buyer, or influencer used to guide messaging and content. / JTBD: Jobs to be done; what the customer is trying to accomplish in a situation.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Who decides to buy the tool, and who uses it each day? Let's define a specific audience and the problem we are solving before choosing the campaign message.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level